Maxfield Allison

Solutions & Infrastructure Architect · Platform Owner · Alabaster, Alabama

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I've spent ten years working with enterprise customers, from field support to global platform ownership. Today I'm the application owner and single global escalation point for an Azure platform serving thousands of devices across four regions. I contribute to architecture decisions, make the case for improvements, and work with the teams responsible for implementing them. Outside work, I run a Kubernetes homelab and direct AI-assisted software projects, including dnsweaver, Plate|Fold and Vacancyd.

Experience

Senior Specialist, Technical Account Support June 2024 - Present
Ricoh USA, Inc. · Customer Engineering Services

- Named application owner and single global escalation point for an enterprise output-management platform on Azure, serving thousands of devices across four global regions.
- Cut platform support tickets 38% year over year, measured in the customer's ServiceNow, through improvements to operations, documentation and self-service.
- Reworking the account's operational data and documentation for use by AI agents and Microsoft Power Automate flows.
- Won funding for a test environment that mirrors production and defined the design, sizing and resource requirements across three organizations. Platform teams own provisioning.
- Found configuration faults in cloud firewalls and microsegmentation, including one breaking DNS globally, and worked with the responsible teams and vendors to get them corrected.
- Contributed to the architecture decisions for the on-premises to Azure migration and the geo-redundancy re-architecture.
- Established procedures for a global support team and coached specialists into primary platform roles.
- Identified which platform servers needed group-policy changes during legacy-protocol remediation. Owned the IIS and application changes and automated internal certificate renewal.
- Wrote the backup and recovery runbook now used company-wide during major platform incidents.
- Earned top-tier customer survey scores and personal recognition from the client; contributed to a five-year contract renewal.

Specialist II, Technical Account Support February 2020 - June 2024
Ricoh USA, Inc.

- Implemented and managed output-management systems for education, healthcare, and multinational corporate clients.
- Led an SNMP v3 security upgrade across several thousand devices at a large healthcare institution.
- Worked alongside vendor and partner engineers on the migration of an on-premises output environment to Azure, verifying the consolidation and correcting errors during rollout.
- Wrote knowledge-base articles and runbooks, and helped client teams work through technical problems and proposed changes.

Site Leader August 2016 - February 2020
Ricoh USA, Inc.

- Met with client leadership to plan service improvements and manage costs. Led a team that met or exceeded quarterly and annual goals.
- Provided support and training for a campus of over 35,000 students, faculty, and staff.
- Met or beat the one-hour service-call response SLA.

Selected Projects

dnsweaver
Open-source tool that keeps DNS records in step with containers and VMs, including support for Technitium, Pi-hole, AdGuard, and Cloudflare. I own the design and releases; AI agents write the code. CI checks tests and security before release.

Plate|Fold
Defined and released Plate|Fold, a cross-platform document-to-PDF tool that keeps wide diagrams and tables readable; directed AI implementation and owned product and release decisions.

Vacancyd
Defined and released Vacancyd, a Rust service that gates borrowed inference work against owner policy and available resources; directed AI implementation and tested its behavior on my workstation.

GitLab, GitOps & Kubernetes Homelab
Talos Kubernetes on Proxmox/Ceph, with ArgoCD managing application configuration. GitLab and the databases stay outside Kubernetes to avoid depending on that cluster during recovery. Linux, macOS and Windows runners support AI-assisted implementation, CI secret scanning and release checks, with Prometheus and Alertmanager for monitoring.

OPNsense (upstream)
Two contributions merged upstream: traffic-shaper packet length (core, 2020) and BGP ECMP maximum-paths with documentation (FRR plugin, 2026, shipped in 1.52).

Skills

Cloud: Microsoft Azure, Azure Front Door, Application Gateway, Load Balancing, Cloud Migration

Platform: Kubernetes, Talos Linux, ArgoCD, GitLab, GitOps, Proxmox VE, Ceph, Docker

Automation & Integration: Terraform / OpenTofu, Ansible, GitLab CI/CD, PowerShell, REST APIs & Webhooks

Architecture & Delivery: Solution Architecture, AI Agent Orchestration & Governance, ServiceNow (CHG / RITM / SCTASK), Knowledge Management, Requirements & Sizing, Stakeholder Management, Customer-Facing Consulting

Operations & Data: Linux, Prometheus / Grafana / Alertmanager, Network Security, Firewalls, SQL Server, Technical Leadership

Certifications

- Microsoft Certified: Azure Fundamentals
- Seven enterprise product certifications: Kofax Equitrac, AutoStore, RightFax, ControlSuite

Recognition

- Specialist of the Quarter (x2), Specialist of the Year, Ricoh STAR Award